

Dummit & Foote: Exercises

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0 Preliminaries

0.1 Basics

For Exercises 1 to 4, let

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

and $\mathcal{B} = \{X \in \mathcal{A} : MX = XM\}$, where $\mathcal{A}$ denotes the set of 2×2 matrices with real entries.

(1) Determine which of the following elements of $\mathcal{A}$ lie in $\mathcal{B}$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solution. Note that the 1st matrix is M itself so that it belongs to $\mathcal{B}$, since $MX = XM = M^2$. Further note that the 3rd, 5th, and 6th matrices are the zero, identity, and exchange matrices respectively. Then the 3rd and 5th belong to $\mathcal{B}$ while the 6th does not. Then only the remaining matrices to check are the 2nd and 4th matrices. For the 2nd matrix:

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Then $MX \neq XM$ and the 2nd matrix does not belong to $\mathcal{B}$. For the 4th matrix:

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

So that $MX \neq XM$. □

(2) Prove that if $P, Q \in \mathcal{B}$, then $P + Q \in \mathcal{B}$ where $+$ denotes the usual sum of two matrices.

Solution. For Exercises 2 and 3, let

$$P = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad Q = \begin{pmatrix} e & f \\ g & h \end{pmatrix}, \quad P + Q = \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix}, \quad P \cdot Q = \begin{pmatrix} ae+bg & af+bh \\ ce+dg & cf+dh \end{pmatrix}$$

where $PM = MP$ and $QM = MQ$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} M(P+Q) &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e+c+g & b+f+d+h \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+c & b+d \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} e+g & f+h \\ g & h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= MP + MQ \\ &= PM + QM \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a & a+b \\ c & c+d \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} e & e+f \\ g & g+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e & a+e+b+f \\ c+g & c+g+d+h \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} a+e & b+f \\ c+g & d+h \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ &= (P+Q)M \end{aligned}$$

□

- (3) Prove that if $P, Q \in \mathcal{B}$, then $P \cdot Q \in \mathcal{B}$ where $\cdot$ denotes the usual product of two matrices.

Solution. Using PQ , proceed as we did above with $M(PQ)$. Rewriting the entries will result in $(MP)Q$. Since $P \in \mathcal{B}$, then we have $(PM)Q$. We rewrite entries again to result in $P(MQ)$. Because $Q \in \mathcal{B}$, we have $P(QM)$, and a final rewrite results in $(PQ)M$. $\square$

- (4) Find conditions on p, q, r, s which determine precisely when $\begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \in \mathcal{B}$.

Solution. Let X be the matrix described above. Note that

$$\begin{aligned} MX &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} p+r & q+s \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \\ XM &= \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} p & p+q \\ r & r+s \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

Because $X \in \mathcal{B}$, then we may compare entries to obtain the following:

$$\begin{cases} p+r=p \\ q+s=p+q \\ r=r \\ s=r+s \end{cases}$$

The first and fourth equations force $r=0$, and the second equation forces $p=s$. Then $\mathcal{B}$ is classified as

$$\mathcal{B} = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} p & p+q \\ 0 & p \end{pmatrix} \mid p, q \in \mathbb{R} \right\} \quad \square$$

- (5) Determine whether the following functions f are well defined:

- (a) $f: \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ defined by $f(a/b) = a$.
 (b) $f: \mathbb{Q} \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}$ defined by $f(a/b) = a^2/b^2$.

Solution.

- (a) No, because $1/2 = 2/4$, but $f(1/2) = 1$ and $f(2/4) = 2$.
 (b) Yes; suppose $a/b = c/d$. Then $ad = bc$, or that $a^2d^2 = b^2c^2$. Then $a^2/b^2 = c^2/d^2$, or $f(a/b) = f(c/d)$. $\square$

- (6) Determine whether the function $f: \mathbb{R}^+ \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ defined by mapping a real number r to the first digit to the right of the decimal point in a decimal expansion of r is well defined.

Solution. No. Note that $1 = 1.000\dots = 0.999\dots$, but $f(1.000\dots) = 1$ and $f(0.999\dots) = 9$. $\square$

- (7) Let $f: A \rightarrow B$ be a surjective map of sets. Prove that the relation

$$a \sim b \iff f(a) = f(b)$$

is an equivalence relation whose equivalence classes are the fibers of f .

Solution. The relation above is an equivalence relation, since $=$ is already an equivalence relation on B .

Consider now some $b \in B$. Since f is surjective, there exists $a \in A$ such that $f(a) = b$. The equivalence class of a is the set $\{x \in A \mid x \sim a\}$. By definition of $\sim$, this is equal to the set $\{x \in A \mid f(x) = f(a) = b\}$, which is precisely the fiber of f over b . $\square$

0.2 Properties of the Integers

1. For each of the following pairs of integers a and b , determine their greatest common divisor, their least common multiple, and write their greatest common divisor in the form $ax + by$ for some integers x and y .

- (a) $a = 20, b = 13$
- (b) $a = 69, b = 372$
- (c) $a = 792, b = 275$
- (d) $a = 11391, b = 5673$
- (e) $a = 1761, b = 1567$
- (f) $a = 507885, b = 60808$

Solution.

- (a) Note: for this exercise, we will only do (e) as that has the most steps in calculating both the g.c.d and the Euclidean Algorithm. The l.c.m is obtained by dividing the product ab by (a, b) .

$$(20, 13) = 1, \text{lcm}(20, 13) = 260, 1 = 2(20) - 3(13)$$

$$(b) (69, 372) = 3, \text{lcm}(69, 372) = 8556, 27(69) - 5(372)$$

$$(c) (792, 275) = 11, \text{lcm}(792, 275) = 19800, 8(792) - 23(275)$$

$$(d) (11391, 5673) = 3, \text{lcm}(11391, 5673) = 21540381, 3 = 253(5673) - 126(11391)$$

- (e) Applying the Euclidean Algorithm to $a = 1761$ and $b = 1567$, we get:

$$1761 = (1)1567 + 194$$

$$1567 = (8)194 + 15$$

$$194 = (12)15 + 14$$

$$15 = (1)14 + 1$$

Then $(1761, 1567) = 1$ so that $\text{lcm}(1761, 1567) = 2759487$. Reversing the Euclidean Algorithm steps to solve for 1, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} 1 &= 15 - 14 \\ &= 15 - (194 - 12(15)) = 13(15) - 194 \\ &= 13(1567 - 8(194)) - 194 = 13(1567) - 105(194) \\ &= 13(1567) - 105(1761 - 1567) = -105(1761) + 118(1567) \end{aligned}$$

$$(f) (507885, 60808) = 691, \text{lcm}(507885, 60808) = 44693880, 691 = 142(60808) - 17(507885) \quad \square$$

2. Prove that if the integer k divides the integers a and b then k divides $as + bt$ for every pair of integers s and t .

Solution. Since $k \mid a$ and $k \mid b$, there exists $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $a = kx$ and $b = ky$. Then for any $s, t \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have $as + bt = kxs + kyt = k(xs + yt)$ which is divisible by k . $\square$

3. Prove that if n is composite then there are integers a and b such that n divides ab but n does not divide either a or b .

Solution. By the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic, n has at least two prime factors a, b such that $1 < a, b < n$. Putting $n = ab$, then $n \mid ab$ but $n \nmid a$ and $n \nmid b$. $\square$

4. Let a, b and N be fixed integers with a and b nonzero and let $d = (a, b)$ be the greatest common divisor of a and b . Suppose x_0 and y_0 are particular solutions to $ax + by = N$ (i.e., $ax_0 + by_0 = N$). Prove for any integer t that the integers

$$x = x_0 + \frac{b}{d}t \text{ and } y = y_0 - \frac{a}{d}t$$

are also solutions to $ax + by = N$ (this is in fact the general solution).

Solution. We have

$$\begin{aligned} ax + by &= a\left(x_0 + \frac{b}{d}t\right) + b\left(y_0 - \frac{a}{d}t\right) \\ &= ax_0 + \frac{ab}{d}t + by_0 - \frac{ab}{d}t \\ &= ax_0 + by_0 = N \end{aligned}$$

$\square$

5. Determine the value $\varphi(n)$ each integer $n \leq 30$ where φ denotes the Euler φ -function.

Solution.

n	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
$\varphi(n)$	1	1	2	2	4	2	6	4	6	4	10	4	12	6	8

n	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
$\varphi(n)$	8	16	6	18	8	12	10	22	8	20	12	18	12	28	8

□

6. Prove the Well Ordering Property of $\mathbb{Z}$ by induction and prove the minimal element is unique.

Solution. Let $A \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be nonempty. If $0 \in A$, then it has a minimal element. Suppose now that $0 \notin A$. Moreover, suppose that $1, 2, \dots, k \notin A$ for some k . By strong induction, it follows that $k+1 \notin A$. However, this results in there being no positive integer in A , contradicting that it is nonempty, thus it must have a minimal element. Moreover, if it had two minimal elements a, b , then it follows that $a \leq b$ and $b \leq a$ by definition of minimal element. Hence, $a = b$, and the minimal element of A is unique. □

7. If p is a prime, prove that there do not exist nonzero integers a and b such that $a^2 = pb^2$ (i.e., $\sqrt{p}$ is not a rational number).

Solution. Suppose $\sqrt{p}$ is a rational number. Then there exists $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $a^2 = b^2 p$, and $(a, b) = 1$. If $(a, b) = d \neq 1$, then take $a' = a/d$ and $b' = b/d$ instead. Then $p \mid a^2 = a \cdot a$, and $p \mid a$. We then have $a = kp$ for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $b^2 = k^2 p$ so that $p \mid b$, and $b = mp$ for $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. This contradicts that $(a, b) = 1$, hence $\sqrt{p}$ cannot be a rational number. □

8. Let p be a prime, $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Find a formula for the largest power of p which divides $n! = n(n-1)(n-2)\dots 2 \cdot 1$ (it involves the greatest integer function).

Solution. Note that in $n!$, there are $\lfloor n/p \rfloor$ integers that are divisible by p , where the greatest integer function is necessary since n may not be a perfect multiple of p (consider $n = 36$ and $p = 7$. Then there are the multiples 7, 14, 21, 28, and 35 which is $\lfloor 36/7 \rfloor = 5$). However, this alone does not account for the factors of p in $n!$, so we move onto p^2 . In this case, there are $\lfloor n/p^2 \rfloor$ integers divisible by p^2 . We continue this process until a certain integer $a \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $p^a \leq n$. (We must bound p^a above by n , up to equality, since n may be a power of p , and any power a such that $p^a > n$ would result in $\lfloor n/p^a \rfloor = 0$). It then follows that $a \leq \log_p(n)$, or that the maximum power of p (and any of its multiples) that divide $n!$ is given by $a = \lfloor \log_p(n) \rfloor$. Thus, the largest power of p that divides $n!$ is given by

$$\sum_{i=1}^{\lfloor \log_p(n) \rfloor} \left\lfloor \frac{n}{p^i} \right\rfloor$$

□

9. Write a computer program to determine the greatest common divisor (a, b) of two integers a and b and to express (a, b) in the form $ax + by$ for some integers x and y .

Require: Integers a, b (not both zero)

Ensure: Integers g, x, y such that $g = (a, b)$ and $ax + by = g$

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1:  $x_1 \leftarrow 1, y_1 \leftarrow 0$ 
2:  $x_2 \leftarrow 0, y_2 \leftarrow 1$ 
3: while  $b \neq 0$  do
4:    $q \leftarrow 0$ 
5:    $r \leftarrow a$ 
6:   while  $(r \geq b)$  or  $(r \leq -b)$  do
7:      $r \leftarrow r - b$ 
8:      $q \leftarrow q + 1$ 
9:   end while
10:   $a \leftarrow b$ 
11:   $b \leftarrow r$ 

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12:    $(x_1, x_2) \leftarrow (x_2, x_1 - q \times x_2)$ 
13:    $(y_1, y_2) \leftarrow (y_2, y_1 - q \times y_2)$ 
14: end while
15:  $g \leftarrow a$ 
16: return  $(g, x_1, y_1)$ 

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10. Prove for any given positive integer N there exist only finitely many integers n with $\varphi(n) = N$ where φ denotes Euler's φ -function. Conclude in particular that φ tends to infinity as n tends to infinity.

Solution. Let $N \in \mathbb{N}$ be fixed, and let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\varphi(n) = N$. We can break apart n into its primes p_i (where $p_1 < p_2 < \dots$) with associated exponents α_i :

$$n = \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\alpha_i} \implies \varphi(n) = \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\alpha_i-1} (p_i - 1) = N$$

In particular, each of the terms $p_i - 1$ divides N so that $p_i - 1 \leq N$, or $p_i \leq N + 1$. It follows that any prime q of some n must be such a prime where $q - 1 \leq N$. Moreover, for some $p_i^{\alpha_i}$ that is a part of n 's prime factorization, it follows that $p_i^{\alpha_i-1}$ divides N . Since $\alpha_i - 1$ is finite, this limits the exponents for any particular p_i . With a finite list of primes and finitely many exponents, it follows that the amount of n such that $\varphi(n) = N$ is finite.

For some $N_0 \in \mathbb{N}$, there are finitely many n such that $\varphi(n) = N_0$. Then there are infinitely many $m > n$ such that $\varphi(m) > N_0$, or that $\varphi(n)$ tends towards infinity. $\square$

11. Prove that if d divides n then $\varphi(d)$ divides $\varphi(n)$ where φ denotes Euler's φ -function.

Solution. Let $n = p_1^{\alpha_1} p_2^{\alpha_2} \dots p_k^{\alpha_k}$ with $d \mid n$. Then d is a composition of some p_i present in n , so some α_i may go to 0 or are less. In particular, we have that $d = p_1^{\beta_1} p_2^{\beta_2} \dots p_k^{\beta_k}$, where $\beta_i \leq \alpha_i$ for all i . To see if $\varphi(d) \mid \varphi(n)$, it follows to check if $p_i^{\beta_i-1} (p_i - 1)$ divides $p_i^{\alpha_i-1} (p_i - 1)$, which further simplifies to checking if $p_i^{\beta_i}$ divides $p_i^{\alpha_i}$ for each i . Clearly, $p_i^{\alpha_i} = p_i^{\beta_i} \cdot p_i^{\alpha_i-\beta_i}$, hence $\varphi(d) \mid \varphi(n)$. $\square$

0.3 $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$: The Integers Modulo n

1. Write down explicitly all the elements in the residue classes of $\mathbb{Z}/18\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned}
\bar{0} &= \{0 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{0, 18, -18, 36, -36, \dots\} \\
\bar{1} &= \{1 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{1, 19, -17, 37, -35, \dots\} \\
\bar{2} &= \{2 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{2, 20, -16, 38, -34, \dots\} \\
\bar{3} &= \{3 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{3, 21, -15, 39, -33, \dots\} \\
\bar{4} &= \{4 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{4, 22, -14, 40, -32, \dots\} \\
\bar{5} &= \{5 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{5, 23, -13, 41, -31, \dots\} \\
\bar{6} &= \{6 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{6, 24, -12, 42, -30, \dots\} \\
\bar{7} &= \{7 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{7, 25, -11, 43, -29, \dots\} \\
\bar{8} &= \{8 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{8, 26, -10, 44, -28, \dots\} \\
\bar{9} &= \{9 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{9, 27, -9, 45, -27, \dots\} \\
\bar{10} &= \{10 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{10, 28, -8, 46, -26, \dots\} \\
\bar{11} &= \{11 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{11, 29, -7, 47, -25, \dots\} \\
\bar{12} &= \{12 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{12, 30, -6, 48, -24, \dots\} \\
\bar{13} &= \{13 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{13, 31, -5, 49, -23, \dots\} \\
\bar{14} &= \{14 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{14, 32, -4, 50, -22, \dots\} \\
\bar{15} &= \{15 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{15, 33, -3, 51, -21, \dots\} \\
\bar{16} &= \{16 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{16, 34, -2, 52, -20, \dots\} \\
\bar{17} &= \{17 + 18k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{17, 35, -1, 53, -19, \dots\}
\end{aligned}$$

□

2. Prove that the distinct equivalence classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ are precisely $\bar{0}, \bar{1}, \bar{2}, \dots, \overline{n-1}$ (use the Division Algorithm).

Solution. Clearly, $\bar{0}, \bar{1}, \bar{2}, \dots, \overline{n-1} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. Let $\bar{a} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. By the Division Algorithm, there exists $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $0 \leq r < n$ such that $a = nq + r$. Then $a \equiv r \pmod{n}$, so that $\bar{a} = \bar{r}$, where r is any one of the aforementioned equivalence classes. Moreover, if $\bar{a} = \bar{b}$ where $0 \leq a, b < n$, it follows that $n \mid (a - b)$ so that $a - b = 0$, or $a = b$. Hence, the equivalence classes of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ are precisely the set above. □

3. Prove that if $a = a_n 10^n + a_{n-1} 10^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 10 + a_0$ is any positive integer then $a \equiv (a_n + a_{n-1} + \dots + a_1 + a_0) \pmod{9}$ (note that this is the usual arithmetic rule that the remainder after division by 9 is the same as the sum of the decimal digits mod 9—in particular an integer is divisible by 9 if and only if the sum of its digits is divisible by 9) [note that $10 \equiv 1 \pmod{9}$].

Solution. Using the note, then

$$\begin{aligned} a &\equiv (a_n 10^n + a_{n-1} 10^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 10 + a_0) \pmod{9} \\ &\equiv (a_n 1^n + a_{n-1} 1^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 1 + a_0) \pmod{9} \\ &= (a_n + a_{n-1} + \dots + a_1 + a_0) \pmod{9} \end{aligned}$$

□

4. Compute the remainder when 37^{100} is divided by 29.

Solution. Note the following:

$$\begin{aligned} 37^2 &\equiv 6 \pmod{29} \\ 37^4 &\equiv 6^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 7 \pmod{29} \\ 37^8 &\equiv 7^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 20 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{16} &\equiv 20^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 23 \pmod{29} \equiv -6 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{32} &\equiv (-6)^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 7 \pmod{29} \\ 37^{64} &\equiv 20 \pmod{29} \end{aligned}$$

Then we have

$$37^{64} 37^{32} 37^4 \equiv 20 \cdot 7 \cdot 7 \pmod{29} \equiv 20^2 \pmod{29} \equiv 23 \pmod{29}$$

Hence the remainder when dividing 37^{100} by 29 is 23. □

5. Compute the last two digits of 9^{1500} .

Solution. Note that $9^3 \equiv 29 \pmod{100}$ so that $29^3 \equiv 89 \pmod{100}$. Then $89 \cdot 9 \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$, or $9^{10} \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$. Since 1500 is a multiple of 10, then $9^{1500} = (9^{10})^{150} \equiv 1^{150} \pmod{100} \equiv 1 \pmod{100}$. Then the last two digits is 01. □

6. Prove that the square of the elements in $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ are just $\bar{0}$ and $\bar{1}$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} 0^2 &= 0 \equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 1^2 &= 1 \equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 2^2 &= 4 \equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 3^2 &= 9 \equiv 1 \pmod{4} \end{aligned}$$

□

7. Prove that for any integers a and b that $a^2 + b^2$ never leaves a remainder of 3 when divided by 4 (use the previous exercise).

Solution. Since a^2 and b^2 is either 0 mod 4 or 1 mod 4, then we have 4 potential sums:

$$\begin{aligned} 0+0 &\equiv 0 \pmod{4} \\ 0+1 &\equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 1+0 &\equiv 1 \pmod{4} \\ 1+1 &\equiv 2 \pmod{4} \end{aligned}$$

In any of the sums, there is no remainder of 3 when dividing by 4. $\square$

8. Prove that the equation $a^2 + b^2 = 3c^2$ has no solutions in nonzero integers a, b and c . [Consider the equation mod 4 as in the previous two exercises and show that a, b and c would all have to be divisible by 2. Then each of a^2, b^2 and c^2 has a factor of 4 and by dividing through by 4 show that there would be a smaller set of solutions to the original equation. Iterate to reach a contradiction.]

Solution. As hinted, consider the equation in mod 4. The left side must be 0 or 1, while the right side must be 0 or 3, hence both sides must be equivalent to 0 mod 4. Then $3c^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$ implies c is even. If a is even, then b is even. If a is odd, then b must be odd. However, putting $a = 2x + 1$ and $b = 2y + 1$ for $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ results in $a^2 + b^2 = (2x+1)^2 + (2y+1)^2 \equiv 2 \pmod{4}$, contradicting that $a^2 + b^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$. It must be that a and b are even. We may then divide the original equation by 4 to get a new equation $r^2 + s^2 = 3t^2$, where $r < a, s < b, t < c$. But then we may use the same reasoning to conclude that the new r, s, t must also be even, resulting in a new equation with smaller integer solutions. This process cannot be iterated indefinitely as we cannot halve any integer indefinitely and remain an integer. Hence, the original equation does not have integer solutions. $\square$

9. Prove that the square of any odd integer always leaves a remainder of 1 when divided by 8.

Solution. Take $a = 2k + 1, k \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then $a^2 = 4k^2 + 4k + 1 = 4k(k+1) + 1$. Note that $k(k+1)$ is even, so that $4k(k+1)$ is divisible by 8. Then $a^2 \equiv 1 \pmod{8}$. $\square$

10. Prove that the number of elements of $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is $\varphi(n)$ where φ denotes the Euler φ -function.

Solution. Recall that $\varphi(n)$ produces the number of integers that are relatively prime to n . It suffices to prove that the elements of $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ are the equivalence classes of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ whose representatives are relatively prime to n .

Let $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Then there exists $\bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} = \bar{1}$. In particular, $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} - \bar{1} = \bar{0}$, or $n \mid (ab - 1)$. Then $n \mid ab - 1$ for $x \in \mathbb{Z}$, which shows that $(a, n) = 1$. Conversely, if $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $(a, n) = 1$, then there exists $b, x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ab + xn = 1$, or $ab \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$. It follows that $\bar{b}$ is the inverse of $\bar{a} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$. $\square$

11. Prove that if $\bar{a}, \bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$, then $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$.

Solution. It follows that there exist $\bar{x}, \bar{y} \in (\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{x} = \bar{b} \cdot \bar{y} = \bar{1}$. In particular:

$$\bar{1} = \bar{1} \cdot \bar{1} = (\bar{a} \cdot \bar{x}) \cdot (\bar{b} \cdot \bar{y}) = (\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b}) \cdot (\bar{x} \cdot \bar{y})$$

So that the multiplicative inverse of $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{b}$ is $\bar{x} \cdot \bar{y}$. $\square$

12. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}, n > 1$ and let $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $1 \leq a \leq n$. Prove if a and n are not relatively prime, there exists an integer b with $1 \leq b < n$ such that $ab \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$ and deduce that there cannot be an integer c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$.

Solution. Since a and n are not relatively prime, then $(a, n) = d$ where $1 < d \leq a$. Then $n/d, a/d \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $a(n/d) = n(a/d) \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$ so that $b = n/d$. Moreover, if there was such a c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, then $abc \equiv b \pmod{n}$, which is false since $ab \equiv 0 \pmod{n}$. Hence, no such b may exist. $\square$

13. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}, n > 1$ and let $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $1 \leq a \leq n$. Prove that if a and n are relatively prime then there is an integer c such that $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$ [use the fact that the g.c.d. of two integers is a $\mathbb{Z}$ -linear combination of the integers].

Solution. Since $(a, n) = 1$, there exists $c, x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ac + nx = 1$. Then $ac \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$. $\square$

14. Conclude from the previous two exercises that $(\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is the set of elements $\bar{a}$ of $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ with $(a, n) = 1$ and hence prove Proposition 4. Verify this directly in the case $n = 12$.

Solution. The previous two exercises show that a and n are relatively prime if and only if there exists b such that $ab \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, which is exactly the proposition. For $n = 12$, the elements 1, 5, 7, 11 are relatively prime to 12, so that $(\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z})^\times = \{\bar{1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{11}\}$ whose inverses are $\bar{1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{11}$ respectively. $\square$

15. For each of the following pairs of integers a and n , show that a is relatively prime to n and determine the multiplicative inverse of $\bar{a}$ in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$.

- (a) $a = 13, n = 20$
- (b) $a = 69, n = 89$
- (c) $a = 1891, n = 3797$
- (d) $a = 6003722857, n = 77695236973$

Solution.

- (a) Refer to the previous set of exercises on how to do the Euclidean Algorithm and how to calculate such an x such that $ax + by = 1$, or $ax \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$. For this exercise, we obtain $-3 \equiv 17 \pmod{20}$, so the inverse is $\bar{17}$.
 - (b) $40(69) - 31(89) = 1 \implies 40 \cdot 89 \equiv 1 \pmod{89}$, so the inverse is $\bar{40}$.
 - (c) $253(1891) - 126(3797) = 1 \implies 253 \cdot 1891 \equiv 1 \pmod{3797}$, so the inverse is $\bar{253}$.
 - (d) $17n - 220a = 1 \implies -220a \equiv 1 \pmod{n} \implies 77695237193a \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$, so the inverse is $\bar{77695237193}$. $\square$
16. Write a computer program to add and multiply mod n , for any n given as input. The output of these operations should be the least residues of the sums and products of two integers. Also include the feature that if $(a, n) = 1$, an integer c between 1 and $n - 1$ such that $\bar{a} \cdot \bar{c} = \bar{1}$ may be printed on request. (Your program should not, of course, simply quote "mod" functions already built into many systems).

1 Introduction to Groups

1.1 Basic Axioms and Examples

Let G be a group.

(1) Determine which of the following binary operations are associative:

- (a) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Z}$ defined by $a \star b = a - b$
- (b) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{R}$ defined by $a \star b = a + b + ab$
- (c) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Q}$ defined by $a \star b = \frac{a+b}{5}$
- (d) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}$ defined by

$$(a, b) \star (c, d) = (ad + bc, bd)$$

- (e) the operation $\star$ on $\mathbb{Q} - \{0\}$ defined by $a \star b = \frac{a}{b}$

Solution.

- (a) Not associative: $(2-0)-2 \neq 2-(0-2)$.
- (b) Associative:

$$\begin{aligned} (a \star b) \star c &= (a + b + ab) \star c \\ &= (a + b + ab) + c + (a + b + ab)c \\ &= a + b + ab + c + ac + bc + abc \\ &= a + b + c + bc + ab + ac + abc \\ &= a + (b + c + bc) + a(b + c + bc) \\ &= a \star (b + c + bc) \\ &= a \star (b \star c) \end{aligned}$$

- (c) Not associative: $(1 \star 0) \star 2 = 11/25, 1 \star (0 \star 2) = 7/25$.
- (d) Associative:

$$\begin{aligned} [(a, b) \star (c, d)] \star (e, f) &= (ad + bc, bd) \star (e, f) \\ &= ((ad + bc)f + bde, bdf) \\ &= (adf + bcf + bde, bdf) \\ &= (adf + b(cf + de), bdf) \\ &= (a, b) \star (cf + de, df) \\ &= (a, b) \star [(c, d) \star (e, f)] \end{aligned}$$

- (e) Not associative: $(1 \star 2) \star 3 = 1/6, 1 \star (2 \star 3) = 3/2$. □

(2) Decide which of the binary operations in the preceding exercise are commutative.

Solution.

- (a) Not commutative: $1 - 0 \neq 0 - 1$.
- (b) Commutative: $a \star b = a + b + ab = b + a + ba = b \star a$.
- (c) Commutative: $a \star b = (a + b)/5 = (b + a)/5 = b \star a$.
- (d) Commutative: $(a, b) \star (c, d) = (ad + bc, bd) = (cb + da, db) = (c, d) \star (a, b)$.
- (e) Not commutative: $1/2 \neq 2/1$. □

(3) Prove that addition of residue classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is associative (you may assume it is well defined).

Solution. Let $\bar{a}, \bar{b}, \bar{c} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. Then $(\bar{a} + \bar{b}) + \bar{c} = \overline{a + b} + \bar{c} = \overline{(a + b) + c} = \overline{a + (b + c)} = \bar{a} + \overline{b + c} = \bar{a} + (\bar{b} + \bar{c})$. □

(4) Prove that multiplication of residue classes in $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is associative (you may assume it is well defined).

Solution. Uses similar reasoning as the previous exercise (where $\cdot$ is associative over $\mathbb{Z}$). $\square$

- (5) Prove for all $n > 1$ that $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ is not a group under multiplication of residue classes.

Solution. Note that in any $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$, $\bar{1}$ is a multiplicative identity. Moreover, there is no $x \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $0x = 1$ so that $\bar{0} \in \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ has no multiplicative inverse. $\square$

- (6) Determine which of the following sets are groups under addition:

- (a) the set of rational numbers (including $0 = 0/1$) in lowest terms whose denominators are odd
- (b) the set of rational numbers (including $0 = 0/1$) in lowest terms whose denominators are even
- (c) the set of rational numbers of absolute value < 1
- (d) the set of rational numbers of absolute value ≥ 1 together with 0
- (e) the set of rational numbers with denominators equal to 1 or 2
- (f) the set of rational numbers with denominators equal to 1, 2, or 3

Solution. Let S denote the set in each part.

- (a) Clearly, $0 \in S$ and for any $r \in S$, then $-r \in S$ is the additive inverse. To prove closure, let $a/b, c/d \in S$, and consider its sum $(ad+bc)/bd$. Since b, d are odd, then bd is also odd. Since having an even factor results in an even number, then any divisor of bd must also be odd. Then $(ad+bc, bd)$ must also be odd, and if we divide both the numerator and the denominator by this quantity, then we still result in odd numbers. Hence, A is closed under addition and is a group.
 - (b) S is not a group, since $1/2 \in S$, but $1/2 + 1/2 = 2/2 = 1/1 \notin S$.
 - (c) Same as previous.
 - (d) S is not a group, since $3/2, 1 \in S$, but $3/2 - 1 = 1/2 \notin S$.
 - (e) Using the Division Algorithm, any $p \in S$ may be split into the form $a + b/2$, where a is even and b is either 0 (if the numerator p is even) or 1 (if the numerator of p is odd). Then if we have $a_1 + b_1/2, a_2 + b_2/2 \in S$ and we consider their sum, then either both b_i is 0 or 1, in which case we remain an integer with denominator 1, or just one of the b_i is 1 in which case we end with a rational with denominator 2 (WLOG, suppose $b_1 = 1$ and $b_2 = 0$. Then we get the rational $(2a_1 + 2a_2 + 1)/2$). Hence, S is closed under addition, and it also has identity 0 and additive inverse $-p$ so that S is a group.
 - (f) S is not a group, since $1/2, 1/3 \in S$, but $1/2 + 1/3 = 5/6 \notin S$. $\square$
- (7) Let $G = \{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid 0 \leq x < 1\}$ and for $x, y \in G$ let $x \star y$ be the fractional part of $x + y$ (i.e., $x \star y = x + y - [x + y]$ where $[a]$ is the greatest integer less than or equal to a). Prove that $\star$ is a well defined binary operation on G and that G is an abelian group under $\star$ (called the *real numbers mod 1*).

Solution. Let $x, y \in G$. Then we have two cases:

- $0 \leq x + y < 1$: Then $[x + y] = 0$, and $x \star y = x + y \in G$,
 - $1 \leq x + y < 2$: Then $[x + y] = 1$, and $x \star y = x + y - 1 \in G$.
- so that $\star$ is well defined on G . To show associativity, let $z \in G$. Then there are three cases:
- If $0 \leq x + y, y + z < 1$, then $[x + y] = [y + z] = 0$:

$$\begin{aligned} (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\ &= x + y + z - [x + y + z] \\ &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\ &= x \star (y \star z) \end{aligned}$$

- If $1 \leq x + y, y + z < 2$, then $[x + y] = [y + z] = 1$:

$$\begin{aligned} (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\ &= (x + y - 1) + z - [x + y - 1 + z] \\ &= x + (y + z - 1) - [x + y + z - 1] \\ &= x \star (y + z - 1) - [x + (y + z - 1)] \\ &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\ &= x \star (y \star z) \end{aligned}$$

- If $1 \leq x + y < 2$ and $0 \leq y + z < 1$, then $[x + y] = 1$ and $[y + z] = 0$. The case of $0 \leq x + y < 1$ and $1 \leq y + z < 2$ is similar:

$$\begin{aligned}
 (x \star y) \star z &= (x + y - [x + y]) \star z \\
 &= (x + y - 1) + z - [x + y - 1 + z] \\
 &= x + y - 1 + z - ([x + y + z] - 1) \\
 &= x + y + z - 1 - [x + y + z] + 1 \\
 &= x + y + z - [x + y + z] \\
 &= x \star (y + z - [y + z]) \\
 &= x \star (y \star z)
 \end{aligned}$$

Then $\star$ is associative. Moreover, commutativity of regular addition implies commutativity of G . For the identity element, note that $0 \in G$ and $0 \star x = x + 0 - [x] = x$. To determine the inverse of some $x \in G$, suppose $w \in G$ such that $x \star w = 0$. Then $x + w - [x + w] = 0$. Note that $0 \leq x + w < 2$, so $[x + w] = 0$ or 1 . If $[x + w] = 0$, then $w = -x$. Since $w, x \in G$, then this is when $x = w = 0$. If $[x + w] = 1$, then $w = 1 - x$ for $0 < x < 1$. Hence, G is closed under inverses and is a group. $\square$

- (8) Let $G = \{z \in \mathbb{C} : z^n = 1 \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$.

- Prove that G is a group under multiplication (called the group of roots of unity in $\mathbb{C}$).
- Prove that G is not a group under addition.

Solution.

- Note that $1 \in G$, so G has an identity. Moreover, if $zz^{-1} = 1$ for some $z \in G$, then $z^{-1} = 1/z \in G$ because $(1/z)^n = 1/z^n = 1$. Lastly, let $z, w \in G$, where $z^n = 1$ and $w^m = 1$ for $n, m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then

$$(zw)^{mn} = (z^n)^m (w^m)^n = 1$$

so that $zw \in G$. Moreover, multiplication is associative in G since $G \subseteq \mathbb{C}$.

- Note that $1, -1 \in G$, but $1 + (-1) = 0 \notin G$, since there is no n such that $0^n = 1$. $\square$

- (9) Let $G = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \in \mathbb{R} : a, b \in \mathbb{Q}\}$.

- Prove that G is a group under addition.
- Prove that the nonzero elements of G are a group under multiplication. [“Rationalize the denominators” to find multiplicative inverses.]

Solution.

- Since $0 + 0\sqrt{2} = 0 \in G$, then G has an identity. Moreover, for any $a + b\sqrt{2} \in G$, it has inverse $-a - b\sqrt{2} \in G$. Associativity in G follows from associativity in $\mathbb{R}$, and for $a + b\sqrt{2}, c + d\sqrt{2} \in G$, we have $(a + b\sqrt{2}) + (c + d\sqrt{2}) = (a + c) + (b + d)\sqrt{2}$, where $a + c, b + d \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that it is closed under addition. Hence, G is a group.
- Since $1 + 0\sqrt{2} = 1 \in G$, then G has identity. Moreover, for $a + b\sqrt{2}$, we take:

$$\frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{a - b\sqrt{2}}{a - b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{a - b\sqrt{2}}{a^2 - 2b^2} = \frac{a}{a^2 - 2b^2} - \frac{b}{a^2 - 2b^2} \sqrt{2}$$

where $a^2 - 2b^2 \neq 0$ (otherwise, then $a/b = \pm\sqrt{2}$, which is impossible). Then G is closed under inverses. Associativity in G follows from associativity of multiplication in $\mathbb{R}$, and for $a + b\sqrt{2}, c + d\sqrt{2} \in G$, we have $(a + b\sqrt{2})(c + d\sqrt{2}) = (ac + 2bd) + (ad + bc)\sqrt{2}$ where $ac + 2bd, ad + bc \in \mathbb{Q}$ so that G is closed under multiplication. Then G is a group. $\square$

- (10) Prove that a finite group is abelian if and only if its group table is a symmetric matrix.

Solution. Let G be a finite group with elements $g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n$ for finite n and $g_1 = 1$. Then G is abelian if and only if $g_i g_j = g_j g_i$ for any i, j if and only if the group table is a symmetric matrix. $\square$

- (11) Find the orders of each element of the additive group $\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z}$.

Solution. For each $\bar{x} \in \mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z}$, add it to itself until we arrive at $\bar{0}$. $|\bar{0}| = 1$, and $\bar{1} = 12$ since $12 \cdot \bar{1} = \bar{12} = \bar{0}$. In particular, we have:

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{0}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{2}$	$\bar{3}$	$\bar{4}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{6}$	$\bar{7}$	$\bar{8}$	$\bar{9}$	$\bar{10}$	$\bar{11}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	12	6	4	3	12	2	12	3	4	6	12

□

- (12) Find the orders of the following elements of the multiplicative group $(\mathbb{Z}/12\mathbb{Z})^\times$: $\bar{1}, \bar{-1}, \bar{5}, \bar{7}, \bar{-7}, \bar{13}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{7}$	$\bar{-7}$	$\bar{13}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	2	2	2	2	1

□

- (13) Find the orders of the following elements of the additive group $\mathbb{Z}/36\mathbb{Z}$: $\bar{1}, \bar{2}, \bar{6}, \bar{9}, \bar{10}, \bar{12}, \bar{-1}, \bar{-10}, \bar{-18}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{2}$	$\bar{6}$	$\bar{9}$	$\bar{10}$	$\bar{12}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{-10}$	$\bar{-18}$
$ \bar{x} $	36	18	6	4	18	3	36	18	2

□

- (14) Find the orders of the following elements of the multiplicative group $(\mathbb{Z}/36\mathbb{Z})^\times$: $\bar{1}, \bar{-1}, \bar{5}, \bar{13}, \bar{-13}, \bar{17}$.

Solution.

$\bar{x}$	$\bar{1}$	$\bar{-1}$	$\bar{5}$	$\bar{13}$	$\bar{-13}$	$\bar{17}$
$ \bar{x} $	1	2	6	3	6	2

□

- (15) Prove that $(a_1 a_2 \dots a_n)^{-1} = a_n^{-1} a_{n-1}^{-1} \dots a_1^{-1}$ for all $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in G$.

Solution. For $n = 1$, the result follows. Suppose it holds for $n = k \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. For $n = k + 1$, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k a_{k+1})^{-1} &= (a_{k+1}^{-1} a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) = (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k) (a_{k+1}^{-1} a_{k+1}) (a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) \\ &= (a_1 a_2 \dots a_k)^{-1} (a_k^{-1} \dots a_2^{-1} a_1^{-1}) \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

The result follows by induction.

□

- (16) Let x be an element of G . Prove that $x^2 = 1$ if and only if $|x|$ is either 1 or 2.

Solution. If $x^2 = 1$, then $|x| \leq 2$. Then $|x| = 1$ or 2. If $|x| = 1$, then $x = 1$, and $x^2 = 1^2 = 1$. If $|x| = 2$, then $x^2 = 1$.

□

- (17) Let x be an element of G . Prove that if $|x| = n$ for some positive integer n , then $x^{-1} = x^{n-1}$.

Solution. Note that $x^n = x^{n-1} x = 1$. Then $x^{n-1} = x^{-1}$.

□

- (18) Let x, y be elements of G . Prove that $xy = yx$ if and only if $y^{-1}xy = x$ if and only if $x^{-1}y^{-1}xy = 1$.

Solution.

$$\begin{aligned} xy &= yx \\ y^{-1}xy &= y^{-1}yx \\ y^{-1}xy &= x \\ x^{-1}y^{-1}xy &= x^{-1}x \\ x^{-1}y^{-1}xy &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

□

(19) Let $x \in G$ and let $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}^+$.

- (a) Prove that $x^{a+b} = x^a x^b$ and $(x^a)^b = x^{ab}$.
- (b) Prove that $(x^a)^{-1} = x^{-a}$.
- (c) Establish part (a) for arbitrary integers a and b (positive, negative, or zero).

Solution.

- (a) Since x^a has a amount of x and x^b has b amount of x , and x^{a+b} has $a+b$ amount of x , the result follows. Similarly, b amount of x^a means there are ab amount of x , or x^{ab} .
- (b) Note that $x^{-a} = (x^{-1})^a$. For $a = 1$, this follows. Suppose $(x^a)^{-1} = (x^{-1})^a$ for $a = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then for $a = n+1$, we have $(x^{-1})^{n+1}(x^{n+1}) = (x^{-1})^n x^{-1} x^n = 1$, which is true by the inductive hypothesis.
- (c) The case where both a and b are positive is done. If $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $b = 0$, then $x^{a+0} = x^a x^0 = x^a$. Moreover, we have $(x^a)^0 = 1$ by definition, so $x^{a \cdot 0} = x^0 = 1$. If $a > 0$ and $b < 0$, we have two cases for the first part of (a):
 - If $a+b > 0$, then $x^a = x^{a+b-b} = x^{a+b} x^{-b}$. Then $x^a x^b = x^{a+b}$.
 - If $a+b < 0$, then $x^b = (x^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-(a+b)+a})^{-1} = (x^{-(a+b)} x^a)^{-1} = (x^a)^{-1} (x^{-(a+b)})^{-1} = x^{-a} x^{a+b}$. Then $x^a x^b = x^{a+b}$.
 For the second part of (a), we have $(x^a)^b = ((x^a)^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-ab})^{-1} = x^{ab}$. Next, the case of $a < 0$ and $b > 0$ is similar. Lastly, if $a < 0$ and $b < 0$, then $x^{a+b} = (x^{-b-a})^{-1} = (x^{-b} x^{-a})^{-1} = (x^{-a})^{-1} (x^{-b})^{-1} = x^a x^b$. Additionally, $(x^a)^b = ((x^a)^{-b})^{-1} = (x^{-ab})^{-1} = ((x^{ab})^{-1})^{-1} = x^{ab}$. $\square$

(20) For x an element in G , show that x and x^{-1} have the same order.

Solution. Let $|x| = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $(x^{-1})^n = (x^n)^{-1} = 1^{-1} = 1$, so $|x^{-1}| \leq |x|$. If $|x^{-1}| = m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, then $x^m = (x^{-1})^{-m} = ((x^{-1})^m)^{-1} = 1^{-1} = 1$, so $|x| \leq |x^{-1}|$. Hence, $n = m$. This establishes that the orders are the same if it is finite; otherwise, both $|x|$ and $|x^{-1}|$ must be of infinite order. $\square$

(21) Let G be a finite group and let x be an element of order n . Prove that if n is odd, then $x = (x^2)^k$ for some $k \geq 1$.

Solution. Put $n = 2k - 1$ for $k \geq 1$. Then $1 = x^n = x^{2k-1} = (x^2)^k x^{-1}$. The result follows. $\square$

(22) If x and g are elements of the group G , prove that $|x| = |g^{-1}xg|$. Deduce that $|ab| = |ba|$ for all $a, b \in G$.

Solution. We first prove that $(g^{-1}xg)^n = g^{-1}x^n g$ by induction. For $n = 1$, the result is clear. Supposing it is true for some $n = k$, then for $n = k+1$, we have $(g^{-1}xg)^{k+1} = (g^{-1}xg)^k (g^{-1}xg) = (g^{-1}x^k g)(g^{-1}xg) = g^{-1}x^{k+1}g$.

Put $|x| = n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Then $(g^{-1}xg)^n = g^{-1}x^n g = g^{-1}1g = 1$ so that $|g^{-1}xg| \leq n$. Similarly, put $|g^{-1}xg| = m$. Then $1 = (g^{-1}xg)^m = g^{-1}x^m g$. Then $1 = x^m$ so that $|x| \leq m$, hence $|x| = |g^{-1}xg|$. Similar to the previous exercise, then both must be of finite or infinite order. Finally, for $a, b \in G$, we have $|ab| = |b(ab)^{-1}| = |ba|$. $\square$

(23) Suppose $x \in G$ and $|x| = n < \infty$. If $n = st$ for some positive integers s and t , prove that $|x^s| = t$.

Solution. Let $|x^s| = r$. Since $1 = x^n = x^{st} = (x^s)^t$, then $|x^s| \leq t$. Moreover, we have $(x^s)^r = x^{sr} = 1$ so that $|x| = st \leq sr$. Then $t \leq |x^s|$. $\square$